

HOW THE EXPERTS PICK THEIR STOCKS

I HELD ANGSTROM INTO THE NEW YEAR, WAITING FOR A BETTER payoff. Meanwhile, I began to interest myself in various stock market newsletters as a possible way of charting my next move. As my chosen stock went up in price, so did my pleasure in reading what other experts had recommended. Several friends showed me their copies of the latest *Zweig Forecast*, *Market Logic*, and *The Prudent Speculator*. I also saw a sample of the *Dick Davis Digest*, which runs excerpts from all the other newsletters. That there's a newsletter of other newsletters proves how complicated this business has become.

Dick Davis and his helpers edit, print, and mail out a bimonthly twelve-pager from an office in Miami Beach. I went there one day and dropped in on him. He told me that he was an ex-stockbroker who soured on that profession twenty years ago. "I was being unfair pretending I knew all the answers. Why not just admit that I didn't know all the answers?" With that in mind, he became a financial journalist and started one of the earliest and most successful Wall Street television programs. After that, he began to write his syndicated column, and then launched his newsletter of newsletters.

"Even if you try to say something 100 percent truthful about the stock market, it's impossible," he told me. "There's always an exception, a caveat, a contradiction. You can never end the sentence." I sympathized with Mr. Davis and mentioned that I'd only recently learned to be a successful investor after years of having been victimized by exceptions and contradictions. By the end of our chat, he'd invited me to attend an investment conference in Fort Lauderdale, where several prominent newsletter writers—